

Harrison and Lillian:

With the ASA Nationals hot on our heels, I can see the pressure building in you both. I can see you aren't vibing off each other the way you need to be to win this thing. I'm not saying this to be critical. Carol and I struggled with the same thing early on, and this silly little thing really helped us, so I want to share it with you.

The other day I was in my office wracking my brain about how to help you two improve. A few of Coach Yantz's sticker sheets fell out of an old souvenir book, and I thought, "Welp, that seems like fate." Old Yantz came up with this self-rating system that he called "sticker talk," which I'm realizing now is a terrible, awful, stupid name. But it worked for me and Carol.

So this is how sticker talk works:

Each shape represents different elements of your performance and each color is how you rate that individual performance element



Circle = Circles

Square = Toe work

Triangle = Flip

Rectangle = Loop

Star = Presentation

Rhombus = Blocks

Heart = Maneuvering

Moon = Neatness

Oval = Determination

Green = Awesome

Red = Excellent

Purple = Underperforming

Orange = Outstanding

Yellow = Improvement needed

This way you combine a shape and color to rate yourself. For example, a star would mean "presentation" and the color orange would set it as outstanding. A purple square would mean the toe work is underperforming. You get the point.

What I want you both to do is rate yourselves after each practice. Eventually you'll rate each other too. It's going to break down your performance into pieces you can improve individually so the whole thing gets better faster.

I know it feels unnatural, but give it a shot. You know I'm rooting for you both!

- Coach N.